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Item 1 of 11

Outline one positive impact of group dynamics on team performance and one negative impact of group dynamic on team performance.

A positive impact of group dynamics on team performance:

By leveraging group dynamics, better ways to solve problems or improve processes can be discovered. Having different perspectives from each team member allows for building and arriving at a solution; likewise, the experience that more veteran members bring can lead to process optimisation.

A negative impact of group dynamics on team performance:

Team misalignment, the lack of clear roles or communication, can cause members to become distracted or deviate from their tasks, and some team members may also put in less effort, assuming that others will complete the work.

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Item 2 of 11

Explain why a team would need a team performance plan.

A team performance plan is essential for maintaining team effectiveness by having a clear understanding of roles, tasks, and objectives to achieve the vision to be fulfilled.

A performance plan ensures there is a direct link between the organisation's high-level strategy and the team's daily actions. When everyone shares the same vision, the team avoids fragmentation because every member knows exactly how their work drives the broader mission forward.

Understanding individual roles is vital where one person's role ends and another's begins. This clarity prevents negative dynamics, such as conflict or confusion over authority, which can otherwise derail a project. Without a plan, it is difficult for the performance team to identify and establish objectives for the professional development of each member to strengthen and promote the continuous development of the team.

By formalising these elements, a team shifts from being a collection of individuals to a cohesive, high-performing unit where the group dynamic becomes a catalyst for success rather than a hurdle.

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Item 3 of 11

Complete the table below to show various methods that can be used to help overcome the following scenarios:

The team needs to complete a project by a certain deadline.

The manager should look for time management methodologies that visualize tasks versus delivery times. For example: Gantt charts or Work Breakdown Structure (WBS).

The team members do not understand the reason for undertaking the project or their own involvement in it.

The manager should build the team performance plan for each member and monitor the fulfillment of tasks/objectives.

I believe that an easy way to communicate is through the RACI Matrix (Responsible, Accountable, Consulted, Informed).

The team members are a diverse group and have many different outcomes in mind.

The manager should develop a team cohesion plan that integrates all feedback from team members and reaches an agreement where everyone understands the performance plan.

They are struggling to organise themselves as a team.

Some ways to obtain feedback are (Open communication processes):

- meetings, either face-to-face
- online or teleconferencing
- online collaboration
- email, telephone or letters
- newsletters/discussion forums
- project communication either by a progress report or email update.

The team are struggling to communicate effectively.

For all team members to follow the same rules, it is necessary to implement Policies and procedures, in this way misunderstandings are avoided.

There have been a few miscommunications lately as some employees are using email and some are verbally providing updates and then forgetting what was said.

Some advantages are:

- The same organizational values, goals and objectives are implemented across the RTO, for example, Codes of Conduct.
- Best practice in the organization is understood and implemented, for example, confidentiality
- There is a shared understanding of particular terms or issues.
- There is a consistency of approach, i.e. work being performed to the same quality over a while, or across some people.

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Item 4 of 11

Provide at least five examples of communications in the workplace which can contribute to team morale and cohesion by completing the table below:

Team Morale	Cohesion
Regular team meetings to keep team members informed and valued, boosting motivation and a sense of belonging	Brings the team together to align on goals and share progress, strengthening group unity
Performance feedback, including recognition of achievements and constructive feedback, encourages members to perform at their best and feel valued.	Constant feedback ensures that all members understand the expectations and reinforces adherence to the same standards and policies.
Open communication processes to allow team members to feel free to express ideas and concerns without fear. It makes them feel respected and engaged.	Transparent communication reduces misunderstandings and builds trust between team members and management.
Conflict resolution communication to address issues promptly and fairly prevents frustration from building up and maintains team morale.	Resolving conflicts through agreed-upon procedures allows the team to function as a cohesive unit.
Policies and procedures communication provides clarity to team members and fosters confidence in operations, reducing uncertainty and stress.	Shared policies and procedures generate consistent behaviour and expectations across the team, thus reinforcing a collective culture.

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Item 5 of 11

In light of the Covid-19 pandemic and employees working from remote locations, provide examples of two tools or techniques for creating collaboration between team members.

1. A new technique: In my personal experience, not much changed since I worked in the IT sector during the pandemic, and collaborative tools were already in use. However, it was necessary to use Sprints to manage all the team's tasks.

2. A new tool: Therefore, we used Trello to manage the backlog and allow each member to collaborate and pick up a colleague's work when they were absent.

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Item 6 of 11

Team leaders need to develop strategies to ensure that their team members have input into planning, decision making and operational aspects of work.

Describe at least three strategies that can be used to accomplish this.

Agile sprint planning & Backlog refinement:

I used to use the Sprint structure to ensure that planning is a collaborative effort. During Sprint Planning, the entire team reviewed the backlog of upcoming technical tasks. Each member provided input on the complexity and effort required for specific user stories.

Facilitating Open Communication and Feedback:

Surveys were conducted with colleagues and clients, which were collected to understand our performance and improve our teamwork.

Decision-making strategy technique:

My colleagues and I often used the Nominal Group Technique to brainstorm ideas for solving complex client challenges. Each team member shared their idea and explained how it had been successfully implemented previously. This way, we could all understand the context of the solution.

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Item 7 of 11

Explain how to give constructive feedback to a team member.

Constructive feedback requires a balance between professionalism and empathy. The most effective approach consists of three key steps:

1. Fully understand the situation (active listening):

Before giving any feedback, it is essential to listen. This means allowing the team member to explain their perspective, showing genuine interest through attentive body language, and avoiding interruptions. A lack of understanding of the situation can lead to unfair or confusing feedback, so active listening ensures that the manager has a complete picture before addressing any issues.

2. Clearly explain what is wrong:

Once the situation is fully understood, feedback should be specific and focus on observable behaviours rather than personal attributes. Using "I" statements helps communicate expectations without triggering defensiveness; for example, "I noticed the report was submitted after the deadline" instead of "You're always late."

3. Acknowledge effort:

Finally, acknowledging the team member's effort is a fundamental part of constructive feedback. This ensures that the person feels valued despite the criticism, maintaining their motivation and morale for the future.

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Item 8 of 11

Explain what is meant by reaching consensus in a team.

Reaching a consensus means facilitating a logical transition from a state of "no communication" or "having different values" to a state where alternatives are clearly defined, evaluated, and combined into a solution that the group can move forward with.

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Item 9 of 11

Describe two strategies for reaching consensus in a team.

Discussing Strengths and Weaknesses:

Once the alternatives are known, the group evaluates them objectively.

The team lists the pros and cons of each specific option.

The goal is to highlight which solution most effectively meets the objective, helping bridge the gap in Level 2 disagreements (different values/experiences).

Merging Alternatives:

Consensus doesn't always mean choosing one winner. Often, the best path is a hybrid.

The facilitator looks for elements in each alternative that everyone likes and combines them with the best parts of other alternatives.

This approach reduces the feeling of "winning or losing," making it much easier for the team to buy into the final decision.

The goal here is to create a new solution that incorporates the values of all stakeholders.

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Item 10 of 11

Outline two ways that issues can be identified by team members.

Open Communication Channels:

Team members can identify problems through established communication platforms, based on open-door policies in team meetings and suggestion boxes. These channels create a safe environment where team members feel comfortable expressing their concerns without fear of criticism. When ground rules are established and an atmosphere of trust and respect is maintained, team members are more likely to communicate and point out problems promptly, before they escalate and affect the performance of the entire team.

Performance Monitoring Based on KPIs:

A team performance plan includes key performance indicators (KPIs) that serve as objective measures of performance. When a team member's performance consistently falls short of their KPIs, this acts as an early warning sign that something is wrong, whether it's a workload issue, a lack of resources, or interpersonal conflict. This can negatively impact the performance of the entire team.

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Item 11 of 11

Describe three strategies a team leader can use to help resolve issues in a team.

Facilitate open communication to reach consensus:

When a problem arises, the team leader should create a safe environment where all members can openly express their views without fear of criticism or retaliation. Ground rules should be established for discussions, and team members should be reminded of their shared goals; this helps refocus the conversation toward a collective solution. The objective of this communication is not to impose a decision, but to facilitate a logical transition from disagreement to a consensus that all members can commit to to move forward.

Clearly communicate expected results:

Once the problem has been discussed, the team leader should clearly explain the expected outcome after its resolution. This involves defining specific and measurable results, linked to the team's KPIs and performance plan, so that each member understands what "resolved" means. Using "I" statements and respectful language helps communicate these expectations without creating defensiveness among team members.

Applying a structured approach to problem-solving: Team leaders can use established problem-solving models to address concerns systematically. This involves identifying the root cause of the problem, evaluating potential solutions as a group, and implementing the most widely agreed-upon approach, monitoring progress based on the team's key performance indicators (KPIs) to ensure the solution's effectiveness.

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